AIKIA.WALLET / FOUNDER PLAYBOOK

One membership card for every Indian business.

Where it fits, what each business type gets, how the system works, what the law requires when money is involved, and what it costs to build, launch and run. Prepared for the founders. October 2026.

Questions this document answers

WHERE DOES IT FIT?

25+ business types across food, fashion, electronics, grocery, health, services, hospitality, education and channel loyalty, with the features each one gets.

HOW DOES IT WORK?

An end-to-end flow chart, a system map, and a customisation grid showing what changes for each business type.

WHAT DOES THE LAW NEED?

Company and tax, RBI rules on stored money, data protection (DPDP), messaging, consumer and security duties, and the order to do them in.

WHAT DOES IT COST?

Three ways to build, run cost at three sizes, and the monthly cost and suggested price for eight kinds of customer.

25+
business types in 9 clusters, from cafes and sweet shops to schools and colleges

5
charts: customer flow, system map, customisation grid, money models, 24-month path

3 build options
costed, with run cost at pilot, growth and scale

How to read the numbers. Market facts come from public sources listed on the last pages; several are vendor or secondary sources and are marked. Costs and prices are planning estimates built from the stated assumptions, not quotes. Legal sections are a research briefing to take to a lawyer and a chartered accountant, not legal advice.

Built on the existing AIKIA.WALLET codebase (Next.js, Supabase, Google Wallet engine, spend tiers, venue wizard, geofencing and campaigns). Internal document. Do not circulate outside the founder group without review.

00 / SUMMARY

The short version

aikia.wallet can serve almost any business that has repeat customers, if we treat it as one membership engine with a small set of rules that each business configures, not as a custom app per industry.

What we sell

A venue-branded card in the customer's phone wallet, a staff scanner, an owner dashboard and a ledger that records every visit and reward. The venue chooses what counts (a purchase, a visit, an attended class), what is earned (stamps, points, tiers, packs, badges) and how members are reached (wallet, WhatsApp, SMS).

Why it can scale

The same ledger and wallet pass serve a 400-member cafe and a 40,000-member supermarket. Differences live in presets, rules and integrations. Sales scale through partners (POS vendors, agencies, brands, distributors), because direct selling to millions of small venues does not pay.

The biggest legal line

Points and visits are low-risk. Stored money (wallet balance, top-ups, transfers) is a regulated payment product under RBI rules. **Recommendation: launch with points only, add venue-run prepaid packs later with counsel, never hold customer money.** Data protection (DPDP Act) applies from day one, and fully from about May 2027.

The money

Build: about Rs 34.9 lakh to Rs 54.5 lakh with a small in-house team over about 8 months (Option B). **Run:** about Rs 2.5 lakh a month at pilot, Rs 9.4 lakh at growth, Rs 38.5 lakh at scale. **Break-even:** roughly 386 paying venues at growth-stage cost, if the average venue pays about Rs 3,500 a month.

What we recommend, in order

1. **Pick three pilot venues** in Wave 1 types (a cafe, a sweet shop or bakery, a salon or court). RUH can be pilot zero for the sweets vertical.
2. **Decide the money model now** (Chart 4): points only. Put venue-run prepaid packs on the Phase 2 list.
3. **Fix the legal base before the first paying customer**: company, GST, trademark check on the name, privacy policy and venue data-processing terms, DLT registration for SMS.
4. **Build the integration and messaging layer next**. POS and WhatsApp are what turn a pilot into a repeatable product.
5. **Treat education as a separate programme**: start with one college campus (the PU PULSE idea) before schools, because minors' data raises the compliance bar.

CONTENTS

What is inside

01 The product in one page: what it is and is not

02 Market: why Indian businesses need this

03 Every business type, cluster by cluster, with features

04 Chart 1: end-to-end flow

05 Chart 2: how the system works

06 Chart 3: what we customise for each business type

07 Education: schools and colleges

08 Feature catalogue, core and add-on modules

09 How to scale: pricing, channels, integrations, stage gates

10 Legal and money: what is needed and in what order

11 Cost to build, cost to run, cost to serve each customer type

12 Running the system: team, operations, support, security

13 Things you may have missed

14 Roadmap, risks, decisions needed, sources

Words used in this document

Qualifying action	The thing that earns progress: a purchase, a completed appointment, an attended class, a scanned invoice.
Ledger	The append-only record of every earn and redeem event. The source of truth. The wallet card only shows it.
Preset	A ready-made configuration for a business type (cafe, salon, school) that a venue can accept in minutes.
Venue-run prepaid	A pack or credit the venue itself sells and honours, with the money collected by the venue. aikia only records balance and use.
PPI	Prepaid Payment Instrument: the RBI term for wallets, prepaid cards and similar stored value.
DPDP	India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 and the Rules notified in November 2025.
DLT, BSP	DLT is the telecom registry for business SMS. A BSP is a WhatsApp Business Solution Provider.

01 / THE PRODUCT

One engine, many shop types

Every loyalty idea in this document is built from the same six parts. A new business type is a new combination of these parts, not a new product.

1. TRIGGER

What counts. A paid bill closed in the POS, a staff scan, a booking marked attended, a class check-in, a teacher marking attendance, a scanned invoice.

2. ACCRUAL

What is earned. A stamp, points per rupee, a visit, a session credit, a house point, a bonus multiplier at off-peak hours.

3. REWARD

What is unlocked. A free item, rupees off, an add-on service, priority booking, a badge, a brand-funded coupon, a guest pass.

4. TIER

Where the member stands. By spend, by visits or by time in the programme: Ink, Chrome, Pink in the current build.

5. LIMITS AND EXPIRY

Caps per day, one-time redemption, points expiry, pack validity, exclusions, reversal on returns or cancellations.

6. CHANNEL

How the member is reached: the wallet card itself, WhatsApp, SMS, a nearby-store alert, a booking or reorder link.

What is already built (from the repository, 8 October 2026)

Area	Status in the codebase
Owner and staff workspaces, invitations, platform console	Built
Member join page, QR poster, phone join, return of existing membership	Built
Spend-based and visit-based tiers, bill amount at the counter	Built
Append-only ledger, idempotent redemption, row-level security	Built
Own Google Wallet engine with AIKIA card layout and tier art; PassKit as a swappable engine	Built; Google public-pass approval and live end-to-end test still to confirm
New-venue wizard, business presets (cafe first)	Built; presets for other types still to write
Geofencing, wallet notifications, offers and campaigns	Built (8 October commit); needs real-venue testing
Apple Wallet	Adapter file exists; waits for the Apple Developer account and certificate
POS or booking integrations, WhatsApp, billing and plans, education module, analytics ROI report	Not built (see the backlog in section 11)

Positioning. The product helps a venue recognise a customer, reward the next visit and measure whether it worked. It is **not** a payment app, a POS, a booking engine, a medical record or a ticketing system, and the pitch must not imply that. The word "wallet" in the name refers to the phone's wallet app; keep sales language on "membership card" so nobody confuses it with a payment wallet.

02 / MARKET

Why Indian businesses need this

The number of possible customers is very large. The question is not whether the market exists but which slice we can serve profitably first.

Rs 5.69 lakh cr
India food-services sector, FY24 (NRAI, as reported); projected Rs 7.76 lakh cr by FY28

12–13 million
kirana stores, industry estimates (not an official count)

1.47 million
schools, UDISE+ 2024-25 (secondary analysis)

48,246
colleges and 1,289 universities, AISHE 2023-24 (newspaper report)

Loyalty market size: sources disagree, so treat as a range

Source	What it measures	Figure
ResearchAndMarkets (2025)	India loyalty programmes market	About US$3.58 billion in 2025, +18.3% on the year
ResearchAndMarkets (later databook)	Same, different base	About US$1.79 billion in 2025 to US$3.91 billion by 2030
Future Market Insights	India loyalty programme market	About US$4.3 billion in 2025 to US$17.1 billion by 2035
MarketsandMarkets	Loyalty *management software* only	About US$648 million in 2025 to US$959 million by 2030 (8.2% CAGR)
Almonds.ai	B2B and channel loyalty	About Rs 25,400 crore, 14% CAGR; says 60% of new 2025 deployments were small and mid-sized businesses

These are vendor-sponsored research pages with different definitions; none is an audited number. The software-only figure (about US$0.65 billion) is the most relevant to what we sell, and even a small share of it is a real business.

What the gap looks like

LARGE CHAINS

Already served by enterprise platforms (custom pricing; Capillary is positioned for enterprise) and by their own apps. They buy on integration depth, security and support. Long sales cycles.

SMALL AND MID-SIZED VENUES

Often use paper punch cards, a WhatsApp list or nothing. Mid-market tools exist (Zoho Loyalty is listed at about Rs 2,000 a month on a competitor's comparison page; unverified). The opening is a card that needs **no app download**, sets up in an hour and is priced like a utility.

EDUCATION

Large institution counts, but mostly served by ERP and fee-payment tools. Digital ID, attendance engagement and campus-merchant networks are thinly served. Higher compliance burden, so fewer fast followers.

OUR EDGE

No-download wallet card; owner-friendly set-up; vertical presets; managed program design from the aikia growth agency; a ledger that is audit-ready from day one.

Competition check still needed. We have not compared features and pricing of Indian competitors in detail (for example Zoho Loyalty, Capillary, POS-bundled loyalty tools, Google Wallet pass vendors, QR stamp-card apps). Do a one-week competitor teardown before fixing prices.

03 / WHERE IT FITS

Every business type we can serve, and what each gets

Organised by how customers behave, because behaviour decides the design. "When" shows the suggested order of attack: Wave 1 first (0 to 6 months), Wave 2 next, Wave 3 only after integrations, security reviews or legal design are ready.

1 Food and beverage

Highest repeat frequency; fastest sales cycle; many already use a POS.

Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Cafes, tea and coffee shops	Each purchase or visit	Stamp card (buy 9, 10th free); points per rupee; happy-hour multipliers; optional venue-run prepaid credit	Stamps, tiers, birthday, geofence nudge, QR poster join	Staff scan speed at peak; fake stamps; free-item cost	WAVE 1
QSR and restaurant chains (multi-outlet)	Bill value, per outlet	Points per rupee with cross-outlet earn and burn; spend tiers; family-combo and birthday offers	Multi-outlet roll-up, POS integration, tiers, WhatsApp, campaign calendar	POS integration is the gate; franchise vs company-owned outlets need separate rules; dine-in vs delivery	WAVE 1
Fine dining, bars and lounges	Bill value, visits	Invite-only tiers, priority tables, event access, anniversary offers	Tiers, reservation link, event passes, anniversary reminders	Alcohol: advertising and promotion rules differ by state. Keep alcohol out of rewards and messages unless counsel clears it	WAVE 2
Sweets, bakeries and namkeen	Bill value; festival orders	Points per rupee; festival-season bonus; reorder reminder; corporate and bulk-order tier	Festival campaigns, gifting codes, reorder reminders, pre-order link	Strongly seasonal (Diwali, Raksha Bandhan); perishable rewards; gift cards need clear expiry	WAVE 1
Ice cream, juice, dessert and cloud kitchens	Each order	Stamp card; free add-on; direct-order incentive to reduce aggregator dependence	Stamps, direct-order link, WhatsApp reorder	Aggregator terms may bar steering customers off-platform; read each platform's rules	WAVE 1

2 Fashion, lifestyle and gifting retail

Higher ticket, lower frequency: loyalty is about occasions, family and recognition.

Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Clothing and boutique stores	Bill value	Spend tiers (Silver, Gold, Black); early access to new arrivals; birthday credit; referral reward	Tiers, birthday and anniversary, referral, size and preference notes, return reversal	Returns and exchanges must reverse points; discount-hunting members; outlet-level stock	WAVE 2
Saree shops and ethnic wear	Bill value; occasions (wedding, festival)	Family account (mother, daughter, in-laws); occasion reminders; spend tiers; private-preview invitations	Family and household link, occasion calendar, referral, WhatsApp, invoice vault	Monthly instalment or advance-savings schemes are a regulated area (see Legal). Do not hold member money without counsel	WAVE 2
Jewellery	Bill value; occasions	Tiers; making-charge benefits; occasion reminders; trade-in and upgrade offers	Tiers, occasion calendar, invoice vault, family link	Gold savings schemes drew regulatory attention in India. Cash-transaction limits and KYC are the jeweller's duty. Do not run schemes through the wallet	WAVE 3
Footwear, bags, accessories, gift shops	Bill value	Points per rupee; seasonal bonus; birthday offer	Points, tiers, referral, geofence	Low frequency: use occasion and season triggers instead of pure points	WAVE 2

3 Electronics, appliances and durables

Low frequency, high ticket: the value is lifecycle, warranty and the next purchase.

Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Electronics and appliance stores (Croma-type)	Bill value; product registration	Warranty vault on the pass; service and AMC reminders; exchange and upgrade bonus; accessory points; brand-funded offers	Document vault, lifecycle reminders, brand-funded offers, multi-outlet, ERP/POS integration	Needs ERP/POS integration; brand co-funding contracts; serial-number data. Enterprise sales cycle	WAVE 3
Mobile and accessories shops	Bill value; service visits	Points on accessories; repair-status link; upgrade reminders	Points, service reminder, referral	Thin margins; counterfeit-accessory trust issues; keep claims factual	WAVE 2

4 Grocery, supermarkets and pharmacies

Highest transaction volume; value comes from basket-building and targeted offers.

Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Supermarkets and hypermarket chains (DMart, Reliance Fresh type)	Basket value; category mix	Targeted coupons by behaviour; paid-membership perks; brand-funded offers; household account	ERP/POS integration, household link, brand-funded offers, multi-store roll-up, analytics	Everyday-low-price formats have thin margins: use targeted offers, not blanket points. Needs enterprise integration, security review and procurement	WAVE 3
Kirana and neighbourhood stores	Each purchase	Stamp card; home-delivery reorder via WhatsApp; brand-funded scheme points	Stamps, WhatsApp reorder, brand-funded offers, very low price point	Very price-sensitive; tiny staff training budget; best reached through distributors and FMCG brands, not direct sales	WAVE 3
Pharmacies and wellness stores	Bill value; refill cycle	Refill reminders; family account; points on wellness and OTC; brand-funded offers	Household link, refill reminders, multi-outlet, POS integration	Health data is sensitive: keep it off the pass. Rules on discounts and inducements for prescription medicines: confirm with counsel	WAVE 3

5 Health, beauty and wellness

Appointment-led repeat visits and prepaid packages.

Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Salons, barbers, spas and nail studios	Completed visit or service	Visit-count reward; service packages with validity; rebook prompt; referral; stylist-wise preference	Stamps, packs (venue-run), rebook link, referral, birthday, validity and renewal	Count only completed appointments; prepaid package expiry must be disclosed; no treatment details on the lock screen	WAVE 1
Gyms, yoga and fitness studios	Attendance (check-in)	Attendance streaks; renewal reminders; referral; class packs; membership freeze and pause	Check-in, validity and renewal, streaks, referral, geofence	Membership billing stays in the gym's system; refunds and freezes need clear terms	WAVE 2
Clinics, dental, diagnostics and optical	Completed visit; recall date	Recall reminders (6-month check-up); family account; referral where permitted	Household link, recall reminders, appointment link	Medical advertising and inducement rules for doctors and clinics are strict. Never store clinical data in the wallet. Counsel review before launch	WAVE 3

6 Auto and home services

Service-interval businesses where the reminder is the product.

Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Car wash, garages and two-wheeler service	Completed service	Wash packs (venue-run); service-interval reminders; referral; loyalty stamps	Packs, service history, reminders, referral	Prepaid packs need expiry and refund terms; keep vehicle data minimal	WAVE 2
Laundry, dry cleaning, tailors and repair	Each order	Stamp card; pickup reminders; prepaid order bundles	Stamps, packs, WhatsApp pickup alerts	Garment-loss disputes sit outside the wallet; keep terms clear	WAVE 2
Pet shops, vets and grooming; florists; bookshops	Each purchase or visit	Stamps and points; birthday (pet or person); refill and re-order reminders	Stamps, occasions, reminders	Small ticket, small budget: keep setup under one hour	WAVE 2

7 Hospitality, sport and entertainment

Bookings, groups and off-peak capacity.

Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Hotels, resorts and homestays	Completed stay or direct booking	Stay-based tiers; direct-booking benefits (to reduce OTA commission); late check-out and upgrade perks	Tiers, direct-booking link, check-in, multi-property roll-up	Booking and payment stay in the booking engine; guest ID data is sensitive	WAVE 2
Turf, pickleball, padel and badminton venues	Attended session	Session packs; off-peak bonus; league tiers; team and captain referral	Check-in, packs, validity, referral, booking link	Booking system owns slots and payment; cancellations must not earn rewards (see the Vertical Expansion Blueprint)	WAVE 1
Gaming parlours, bowling, trampoline parks, cinemas	Visit or ticket	Visit stamps; group offers; birthday-party benefits; off-peak passes	Stamps, packs, birthday, geofence, multi-site	Ticketing and timed entry are a separate system; minors need parental consent	WAVE 2

8 Education

Not 'points for spending' but identity, attendance, engagement and a campus economy. Longer sales cycles and stricter data rules (minors).

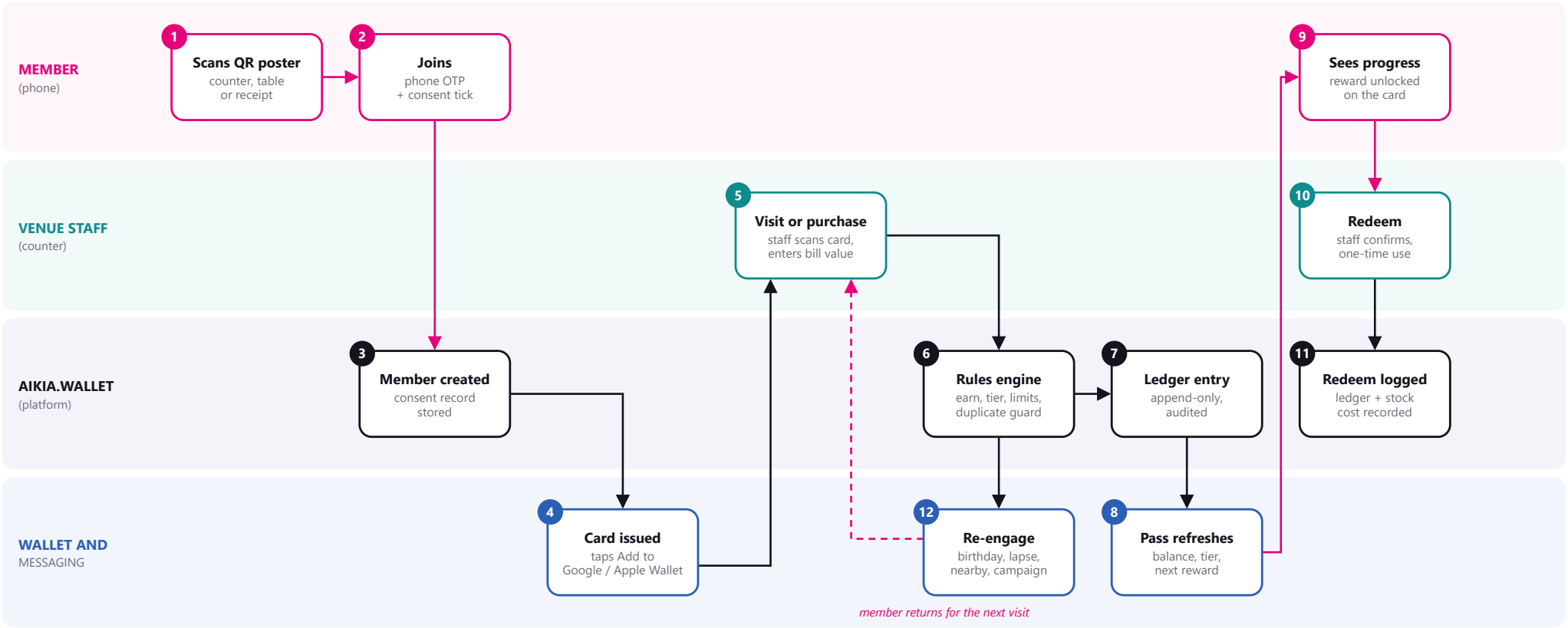
Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Schools (K-12)	Attendance, reading, activities, on-time actions	Non-monetary badges and house points; digital student and parent pass; canteen or stationery credit run by the school; event and PTM reminders	Student and parent profile, parental consent, attendance check-in, notices, multi-branch	Under-18 data needs verifiable parental consent; no tracking, behavioural monitoring or targeted advertising to children; fee rules differ by state	WAVE 3
Colleges and universities	Attendance, events, campus spend, placement milestones	Digital campus ID; library and hostel pass; fest and event tickets; campus-merchant discount network; alumni membership	Student profile, campus coalition, event passes, check-in, validity	Coalition with merchants adds liability and GST questions; many students are 18+ but some are not; institution is the data fiduciary	WAVE 3
Coaching, tuition, music, dance and hobby classes	Class attendance	Attendance streaks; renewal reminders; sibling and referral benefits; batch reminders	Check-in, validity and renewal, referral, parent profile	Fee collection stays with the institute; reminders only. Parents are the consent-givers for minors	WAVE 2

9 Adjacent opportunities (later)

Reachable once the core is proven; each needs its own product and legal design.

Business type	What counts	Reward ideas	Standout modules	Watch-outs	When
Malls, markets and city coalitions	Spend across member merchants	Shared points across merchants; mall-level tiers	Coalition ledger, settlement between merchants, shared analytics	Cross-merchant redemption creates settlement, GST and liability questions. Design after the single-venue product is stable	WAVE 3
Dealer and channel loyalty (electricians, painters, distributors)	Product or invoice scan	Points per scan or invoice; tier rewards; brand-funded incentives	Brand console, scan-per-pack, KYC, payout	TDS on business benefits (Section 194R) and payout rules apply; a different product from consumer loyalty	WAVE 3
Clubs, societies, trusts and event organisers	Membership, attendance	Membership pass, renewal, event entry	Validity, check-in, member directory	Donations and trusts have their own rules (80G, FCRA); do not process donations without counsel	WAVE 3

Chart 1. End-to-end flow: from first scan to repeat visit



The ledger (step 7) is the source of truth. The wallet card is a synchronised display of it. No money moves through aikia.wallet in this flow: points and visits only.
Pink arrows = what the member sees and does. Dashed = automated re-engagement, only for members who gave consent.

JOINING (STEPS 1 TO 4)

A QR poster or link starts it. The member gives a phone number and ticks consent once; the platform stores the consent record and issues the card. No app to download.

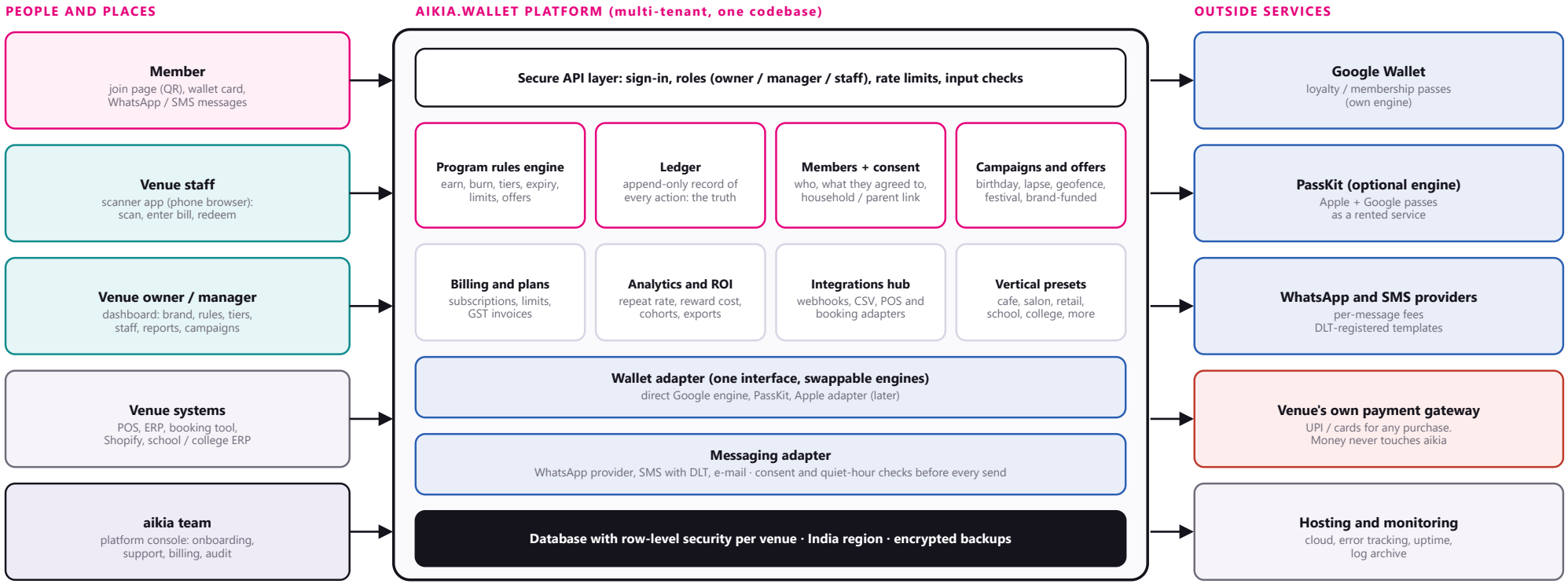
EARNING (STEPS 5 TO 8)

Staff scan the card and enter the bill or mark the visit. The rules engine applies earn rules, tier moves and limits, and blocks duplicates. The result is written to the ledger and the card refreshes.

REDEEMING AND RETURNING (9 TO 12)

When a reward unlocks, staff confirm it once and the cost is logged. Automated, consent-based messages (birthday, lapse, nearby, campaign) bring the member back to step 5.

Chart 2. How the system works: building blocks and who touches what



The platform is one product configured per venue. New business types are solved with presets and rules first, custom code last.

WHO TOUCHES WHAT

Members use the join page and the wallet card. Staff use the scanner. Owners use the dashboard. Only the aikia team uses the platform console, and every action there is logged.

WHAT STAYS SWAPPABLE

The wallet engine and the messaging provider sit behind adapters, so a provider's price rise or rule change does not force a rebuild.

WHERE MONEY IS

Payments for purchases go through the venue's own gateway. The platform records rewards and visits, not funds.

06 / CHART 3

What we customise for each business type

● core for this type ◐ optional blank = not used. Modules are switched on per venue by the preset; nothing here needs custom code.

Business type	Points per rupee	Visit stamps	Spend tiers	Prepaid packs (venue-run)	Appointment / booking link	Membership validity + renewal	Family / household	Student / parent profile	Referral	Birthday + occasions	Multi-outlet roll-up	POS / ERP integration	Geofence + wallet alerts	WhatsApp / SMS	Document / warranty vault	Check-in / attendance	Brand-funded offers
FOOD AND BEVERAGE																	
Cafe / tea shop	◐	●	◐	◐					◐	●	◐	◐	●	●			
QSR / restaurant chain	●	◐	●	◐			◐		◐	●	●	●	●	●			◐
Sweets / bakery	●	◐	◐	◐			◐		◐	●	◐	◐	◐	●			
FASHION AND GIFTING																	
Clothing / boutique	●		●				◐		●	●	◐	●	◐	●			
Saree / jewellery	◐		●				●		●	●	◐	◐	◐	●	◐		
ELECTRONICS AND GROCERY																	
Electronics / appliances	◐		◐			◐	◐		◐		●	●	◐	●	●		●
Supermarket chain	●		◐			◐	●		◐	◐	●	●	●	●			●
Kirana store	◐	●					●		◐					●			●
Pharmacy	◐					◐	●		◐		●	●	◐	●			●
HEALTH AND SERVICES																	
Salon / spa	◐	●	◐	●	●	●	◐		●	●	◐	◐	◐	●			
Gym / yoga studio		◐	◐	◐	◐	●	◐		●	◐	◐	◐	●	●		●	
Clinic / dental / optical					●	◐	●		◐	◐	◐			●	◐	◐	
Car wash / garage	◐	●	◐	●	●	◐			●		◐	◐	◐	●	◐		◐
HOSPITALITY AND SPORT																	
Hotel / homestay	●		●		◐	◐	◐		◐	●	●	◐	●	●		◐	◐
Turf / pickleball / courts		●	◐	●	●	●			●	◐	◐	◐	◐	●		●	
Gaming / bowling / cinema	◐	●	◐	●	◐	◐	◐		◐	●	●	◐	●	●		◐	◐
EDUCATION																	
School (K-12)		◐		◐	◐	◐	●	●		◐	●	◐	◐	●		●	◐
College / university	◐	◐	◐	◐		●		●	◐		●	◐	●	●	◐	●	●
Coaching / hobby classes		●		◐	◐	●	◐	●	●	◐	●	◐		●		●	
CHANNEL																	
Dealer / channel loyalty	●		●						◐		●	◐		●			●

06 / CHART 3 (CONTINUED)

The same six parts, set four different ways

Part	Cafe	Salon	Supermarket chain	School
1. Trigger	Paid order at counter	Appointment marked completed	Bill closed in POS	Teacher marks attendance or activity
2. Accrual	1 stamp per order; 2x in the 3-5 pm slow window	1 visit per service; rupees spent tracked	1 point per Rs 100; 2x on brand-funded items	House points and badges (no cash value)
3. Reward	Free drink at 10 stamps	Free add-on at 5th visit; pack of 6 at a set price	Rupees off at 500 points; targeted coupons	Certificate, recognition, canteen credit funded by the school
4. Tier	None, or Regular / Gold	Silver / Gold by visits per year	Household tiers by monthly spend	None (avoid ranking children)
5. Limits and expiry	Stamps expire in 6 months; 1 scan per order	Pack valid 90 days; no reward on cancelled bookings	Points expire in 12 months; reverse on returns	Term-end reset; parent can view and withdraw consent
6. Channel	Wallet alert near the shop; WhatsApp offer	"Book again" link; reminder 4 weeks later	Wallet + WhatsApp; targeted by basket history	Notices to parents with consent; no ads to children

Different businesses, different primary job

Behaviour	Examples	The card's main job
High frequency, low ticket	Cafes, tea stalls, kiranas, bakeries, juice bars	Make the next purchase habitual: stamps and quick scans
Appointment-led	Salons, clinics, gyms, garages, tutors	Make rebooking easy; protect against no-shows; reminders
Occasion-led, high ticket	Sarees, jewellery, electronics, furniture	Recognise the family, remember occasions, hold invoices and warranties
Basket-led, thin margin	Supermarkets, pharmacies	Targeted offers, household accounts, brand-funded rewards
Capacity-led	Turfs, courts, games, cinemas, hotels	Fill quiet hours; reward attended sessions; team referral
Identity and engagement	Schools, colleges, coaching, clubs	Digital ID and pass, attendance, notices, campus network

07 / EDUCATION

Schools and colleges

In education the product is a digital identity and engagement pass, not a spend-and-earn card. Rewards are mostly recognition, access and campus convenience. The compliance bar is higher because many users are children.

Colleges and universities

- **Campus ID pass** in the phone wallet: library, hostel, lab, bus, exam hall.
- **Attendance and event check-in** by QR; festival and fest tickets.
- **Campus merchant network**: cafeteria, stationery, print shops and nearby cafes give student discounts. The college earns from the network; students use one card. This is the PU PULSE idea.
- **Placement and alumni**: milestones, alumni membership with renewal and event access.
- **Notices** from departments, with opt-in.

Sales: Registrar, student affairs or the innovation cell; pilot with one department or hostel before a campus rollout.

Schools (K–12)

- **Parent-owned account** with child sub-profiles. The adult is the contract party and consent-giver.
- **Student pass**: ID, library, bus, canteen, event entry.
- **Recognition, not ranking**: badges, reading streaks, house points. No public leaderboards of children.
- **School-run canteen or stationery credit** as venue-run prepaid, never held by aikia.
- **Parent notices**: PTM reminders, holidays, event passes.

Sales: Principal and trustees; longer cycle, annual contract, per-campus pricing.

Education rules to design in from day one

Issue	What the research says	Design response
Children's data	DPDP Rules: processing data of anyone under 18 needs verifiable parental consent; tracking, behavioural monitoring and targeted advertising directed at children are prohibited. These duties apply from about May 2027.	Parent-first accounts; no marketing messages to children; no behavioural scoring; parent can view and delete the child's record.
Who is responsible for the data	The institution decides purpose and means, so it is the "data fiduciary"; aikia is typically its processor.	Data-processing agreement with every institution; institution-owned admin; export and exit rights.
Fees	School fee regulation varies by state.	Reminders only. Do not collect fees or give fee discounts through the wallet without counsel and institution approval.
Campus merchant coalition	Cross-merchant redemption raises settlement, GST and liability questions.	Start with merchant-funded discounts at each merchant's own counter; no shared balance.
Procurement	Institutions buy slowly and ask for security evidence.	Prepare a security summary, a DPA, uptime history and references from a pilot campus.

To confirm: state-specific school regulations, UGC / AICTE guidance on student data and ID, and whether the institution's own policies bar third-party apps. Take these to counsel before the first education pilot.

08 / FEATURES

Feature catalogue

What every venue gets, what is switched on by preset, and what is a paid add-on. The core is shared; the add-ons are where verticals differ and where pricing steps up.

Core (every plan)

- Venue-branded wallet card; QR join page; QR poster generator
- Member profile, consent record, phone verification
- Staff scanner with roles; duplicate-scan guard
- Stamps or points; tiers; rewards and one-time redemption
- Owner dashboard: members, activity, reward cost
- Append-only ledger; data export
- Setup wizard and vertical preset

Growth add-ons

- WhatsApp and SMS campaigns with consent and quiet hours
- Birthday, anniversary and lapse automations
- Geofence alerts and offers
- Referral programme
- Packs and validity (venue-run prepaid)
- Appointment or booking link; check-in
- ROI report: repeat rate, reward cost, cohorts

Business and enterprise add-ons

- Multi-outlet and franchise roll-ups
- POS, ERP, Shopify and booking integrations
- Brand-funded offers and co-op campaigns
- Household / family accounts
- Document and warranty vault
- Single sign-on, API and webhooks, audit export
- Priority support and SLA

Education add-ons

- Student and parent profiles; parental consent flow
- Campus ID, library, hostel, bus passes
- Attendance and event check-in
- Campus merchant network
- Department admins and notices
- Alumni membership and renewal

Wallet card behaviour to know

- **Google Wallet** works for Android users now. Developer-authored push messages are reported as not supported by Google's own FAQ; third-party sources describe limited update notifications (about three per pass per 24 hours, near a relevant time). Plan on card updates, geofence-style alerts and WhatsApp for outreach, and verify the current Google rules before promising any message type.
- **Apple Wallet** needs the Apple Developer account and a pass certificate. Until then, iPhone users need a fallback: a web card or a PassKit-issued pass.
- **Feature-phone and no-wallet users** need a fallback card (a link that shows a QR and balance) and SMS notices.
- **A pass shows data on the lock screen.** Keep anything sensitive (treatment, medical, student grades) off it.

09 / HOW TO SCALE

From three pilots to thousands of venues

1. Productise before you grow

Write one preset per vertical, one onboarding checklist per vertical, one reporting template per vertical. A new venue should go live in under an hour with no developer. Every request for "custom" is first tried as a rule or preset.

2. Integrations are the real scaling lever

Chains will not key a bill into a second screen. Wave 1 integrations should cover the POS tools your target venues already use, Shopify for online-first brands, one booking tool for salons and courts, and a CSV or webhook fallback. Confirm each vendor's API access terms before promising.

3. Sell through partners

Direct selling to millions of small venues does not pay. Partners who already visit venues: POS resellers, accounting and GST consultants, payment-device agents, distributors and FMCG field teams (brand-funded kirana programmes), franchise consultants, college innovation cells, and the aikia agency's own clients.

4. Price on value, not on features

Anchor on repeat revenue the venue can see. Keep three plans, publish them, and charge setup only for managed work (program design, creative, training).

Pricing hypotheses to test with pilots (not market-validated)

Plan	For	Per month	Includes
Starter	Single outlet cafe, bakery, boutique, kirana	Rs 999 to 1,499	Core, 1 preset, 500 active members, 200 utility messages
Growth	Salon, gym, court, restaurant with up to 3 outlets	Rs 1,999 to 2,999	Starter + campaigns, referral, packs, booking link, ROI report, 2,000 active members
Business	Chains, hotels, schools, colleges	Rs 9,999 and up, per outlet or campus	Growth + multi-outlet, integrations, API, priority support
Enterprise	Supermarkets, electronics, large education groups	Custom (about Rs 1.5 lakh+)	Business + SLA, security review, dedicated manager
Managed program (add-on)	Any venue wanting aikia to run the programme	Setup Rs 5,000 to 25,000; monthly retainer	Programme design, creative, staff training, campaign calendar, reporting
Messaging	All	Pass-through at cost +30%	WhatsApp and SMS billed per message after the allowance

Stage gates

Stage	Venues	What must be true before moving on
Prove	1 to 3	Repeat visits measurably up versus a baseline; staff scan in under 10 seconds; owner would pay; no legal blocker.
Repeat	10 to 25	Set-up under one hour; support under about 1 hour per venue per month; churn understood; two referenceable owners.
Systemise	25 to 250	Integrations live; self-serve onboarding; billing automated; monitoring and on-call in place; DPDP controls working.
Expand	250 to 2,000	Partner channel producing leads; enterprise security pack; regional language support; second wallet engine live.

Starting advantage. You already run a growth agency with clients, a Wave 1 sweets brand (RUH), and a campus concept (PU PULSE). These are the fastest routes to the first pilots and references.

Chart 4. Three ways money can appear in the product, and our recommendation

A. Points and visits only

No cash value, no stored money

Venue gives rewards for purchases or visits.
aikia keeps the ledger.

START HERE

B. Venue-run prepaid credit or packs

Venue sells its own packs, redeemable only at that venue

Venue collects money through its own gateway.
aikia only records balance and use.

PHASE 2, WITH COUNSEL

C. aikia holds or moves money

Wallet balance, top-up, transfer, cross-merchant spend

aikia would be issuing or operating a payment product.
Needs RBI authorisation or a licensed partner.

DO NOT BUILD YET

The single most important legal decision is which of these three the product does. Everything else in the legal section follows from it.

A. WHAT WE NEED

Clear programme terms, expiry rules, consent, a ledger that can report points issued, redeemed and expired. No RBI authorisation is expected to be needed for points with no cash value and no cash-out, but get that in writing from counsel.

B. WHAT WE NEED

Pack terms (validity, refund, transfer, expiry), the venue collecting money in its own account, consumer-law review, and a design where the balance can be spent only at that venue. Wait for the final RBI direction before launch.

C. WHAT IT WOULD TAKE

RBI authorisation as a prepaid-instrument issuer (reported net worth thresholds of Rs 5 crore rising to Rs 15 crore under the 2026 draft) or a partnership with a licensed bank or issuer. Not a start-up-stage project.

What the law touches, in the order you meet it

> **Not legal advice.** This is research to brief a lawyer and a chartered accountant. Several rules are new or still in draft (RBI PPI draft of 2026, DPDP phase-in). Confirm each item below before relying on it.

A. The company, tax and name

Item	What and why	Rough cost
Private limited company	Contracting party for venues, owner of IP, signs data-processing terms. SPICe+ incorporation; MCA fee nil up to Rs 15 lakh authorised capital; stamp duty varies by state.	Rs 7,000 to 25,000 all-in (sources vary)
GST registration and invoicing	Our subscription is a taxable service (commonly 18%; confirm with your CA). Issue GST invoices; claim input credit on tools and messaging.	CA retainer, see section 11
Startup recognition (optional)	DPIIT recognition can ease some compliances and tax matters; check eligibility with your CA.	Low
Trademark check on the name	Search "aikia", "aikia.wallet" and logo before spending on brand. "Wallet" in the name can also draw regulator and customer confusion with payment wallets.	Search plus filing: verify current government fees; allow professional fees
Founders' agreement, IP assignment	Everyone who writes code or design signs IP assignment to the company, including contractors and agencies.	Lawyer time

B. Money: the RBI line

- **Prepaid payment instruments (PPIs)** are regulated by the RBI. The 2021 Master Direction treats a "closed system" PPI (usable only to buy the issuer's own goods and services, no cash-out, not usable for third-party payments) as outside the authorisation requirement. Gift instruments were capped at Rs 10,000 and are non-reloadable.
- **Draft 2026 changes (comments were due 22 May 2026; final status not confirmed in this research).** The draft reportedly removes the closed-system category but keeps an exemption for PPIs issued by entities that are not marketplaces. Marketplace-issued PPIs would need a licensed issuer. Non-bank applicants would need a net worth of Rs 5 crore, rising to Rs 15 crore.
- **What this means for us.** A venue honouring its own pack at its own counter is the safest shape. A wallet balance usable across venues, on a marketplace, or transferable between people moves into licensed territory. Loyalty points with no cash value and no cash-out are generally treated differently from PPIs, but this research did not find RBI text that says so directly: ask counsel for a written view.
- **Payment aggregation.** If aikia collected customers' payments for venues and settled to them, it would be acting as a payment aggregator, which the RBI's 2025 directions regulate (authorisation required, with net-worth thresholds of Rs 15 crore at application rising to Rs 25 crore, per press reports). Avoid: let each venue use its own gateway account.
- **Savings and instalment schemes.** Jewellers, saree shops and others run "pay monthly, redeem later" schemes. These can fall under rules on unregulated deposits and chit schemes. Do not offer or administer them through the product without counsel.

C. Tax treatment of rewards

- GST on vouchers and gift cards is a developing area: tribunals and advance-ruling bodies have held that tax is levied on the underlying supply at redemption rather than on the voucher itself (for example the Kalyan Jewellers appellate ruling cited in commentary). Reward points were once characterised as actionable claims. The venue's CA should decide treatment; aikia should make the ledger able to report issued, redeemed and expired points by period.
- For dealer and channel incentives, TDS on business benefits (Section 194R) can apply to the payer; confirm limits with a CA before building channel loyalty.

Data, messaging, consumers and security

D. Data protection: DPDP Act 2023 and Rules 2025

Topic	What applies	What we build or sign
Timeline	Rules notified November 2025. Data Protection Board set up at notification; consent-manager registration about 12 months later; core duties (notice, consent, safeguards, breach intimation, children's data, rights) apply about 18 months after notification, around May 2027. Check the Gazette for exact dates.	Build to the final standard now; do not wait for the date.
Roles	Each venue decides why and how member data is used, so it is the data fiduciary. aikia, acting on its instructions, is a data processor.	Data-processing agreement in every venue contract.
Notice and consent	Plain-language notice; specific, informed, withdrawable consent; the Act allows notice in English or any of the 22 scheduled languages.	Join page with notice and separate ticks for marketing; consent log; language options.
Rights and grievance	Access, correction, erasure, grievance redress, nomination.	Member self-service request page; grievance contact; 30-day internal SLA target.
Security and breach	Reasonable security safeguards; breach intimation to the Board and affected people. Penalties reported up to Rs 250 crore for safeguard failures and up to Rs 200 crore for breach-notice and children's-data failures (sources differ; verify in the Act's schedule).	Row-level security, encryption, access logs, tested incident runbook, cyber insurance.
Children	Under-18: verifiable parental consent; no tracking, behavioural monitoring or targeted ads.	Parent-first education design (section 07).
Retention	Erase when purpose ends unless law requires retention.	Retention schedule per data type; automatic deletion jobs.

E. Messaging

- **SMS:** register the company as a principal entity on a telecom operator's DLT platform (one-time fee reported around Rs 5,900), then register sender headers and templates. Unregistered business SMS is blocked.
- **WhatsApp:** use an official Business Solution Provider. Meta India rates reported for 2026: about Rs 0.86 per marketing message and Rs 0.115 per utility message, plus provider markup and GST. Templates need approval; opt-in must be recorded. Check Meta's rate card before pricing; it changes.
- **Promotional hours and do-not-disturb:** promotional messages are limited by time of day and by the national preference registry. Confirm the current TRAI rules with the SMS provider.

F. Consumers and advertising

- Consumer Protection Act 2019 covers unfair trade practices and misleading advertisements. Programme terms must be clear on earn, expiry, exclusions and change of terms; changing rules after points are earned is a classic dispute.
- The Central Consumer Protection Authority's 2023 guidelines on dark patterns apply to consent screens, false urgency and hidden terms. Avoid "only 2 left" style pressure and pre-ticked marketing boxes.
- ASCI advertising codes apply to offer claims. A "free" reward must be free of hidden conditions.

G. Cyber security

- CERT-In directions (28 April 2022): report cyber incidents within 6 hours of becoming aware; keep logs for 180 days within India; synchronise clocks to government time sources; name a point of contact.
- Run an independent web-application penetration test before the first large customer and yearly. Enterprise and education buyers will ask for the report. ISO 27001 or SOC 2 is a later step.

H. Sector-specific cautions

Sector	Caution
Bars and liquor	Alcohol promotion rules differ by state; keep alcohol out of rewards and messages unless counsel clears it.
Pharmacies, clinics, dentists, opticians	Health data is sensitive; medical advertising and inducement rules for professionals are strict; rules on discounts for prescription medicines. No clinical data on the pass.
Jewellery, saree and gold schemes	Deposit and chit-scheme rules; cash-transaction and KYC duties sit with the shop.
Education	Children's data, state fee regulation, institution policies (section 07).
Trusts, NGOs, clubs	Donations raise 80G and FCRA questions; do not process donations.

The documents and the procedure

Documents to have before the first paying customer

Document	Between	Must cover
Master subscription agreement	aikia and venue	Scope, plans, fees, GST, term, support hours, uptime goals, limits of liability, exit and data return.
Data-processing agreement	aikia and venue	Roles, purposes, security measures, sub-processors (cloud, wallet, messaging), breach duties, deletion on exit.
Member privacy notice (template)	Venue and member	What is collected, why, who sees it, rights, grievance contact. Languages.
Programme terms (template)	Venue and member	Earn rules, expiry, exclusions, changes with notice, fraud, disputes.
Acceptable-use and staff rules	Venue and its staff	No self-scanning, no sharing cards, audit trail.
Sub-processor list	Public page	Cloud host, wallet engine, messaging providers, analytics.
Wallet platform terms	aikia and Google / Apple / PassKit	Read and comply; platforms can change terms or suspend issuers. Keep the engine swappable.
Partner and reseller agreement	aikia and channel partner	Commission, territory, data access limits, brand use.
Incident response and breach-notice plan	Internal	Who decides, 6-hour CERT-In report, Board and member notices, venue notice.

Procedure, step by step

1. **Week 1.** Incorporate; open a current account; GST registration; engage a CA and a technology lawyer on retainer.
2. **Week 2.** Trademark search and filing decision; founders' agreement and IP assignment; domain and brand assets locked.
3. **Weeks 2 to 3.** Decide the money model (points only) and get counsel's written view on points versus PPI, and on the venue-run pack design for Phase 2.
4. **Weeks 3 to 4.** Draft the six core documents above; map personal data (what is collected, where it lives, who sees it); decide retention periods.
5. **Weeks 4 to 6.** DLT registration; WhatsApp provider onboarding and templates; consent screens built and tested; grievance and breach processes written.
6. **Before the first customer.** Independent security test; backup restore test; cyber insurance quote; pilot venue signs the agreement and DPA.
7. **Every quarter.** Review regulator updates (RBI PPI final text, DPDP dates, TRAI changes); update documents; re-test breach drill.
8. **Every year.** Penetration test; sub-processor review; accounts and GST filings; insurance renewal.

> **Costs of this section** are in section 11. The cheapest way to stay safe is to keep money out of the product, keep data minimal, and make every member consent and every ledger entry traceable.

11 / COSTS

Cost to build

What is still to build, and three ways to deliver it. The existing codebase already covers the core, so these figures are for the remaining work, not a from-scratch build.

Work package still to build	Person-months
Multi-tenant billing: plans, limits, subscriptions, invoices	2.0
Rules engine v2: points per rupee, stamps, expiry, tiers, offer templates	2.5
Vertical presets and self-serve onboarding wizard	1.5
Staff scanner: offline mode, fraud and duplicate-scan controls	2.0
Integrations wave 1: three POS systems, Shopify, one booking tool, CSV	3.0
Apple Wallet adapter and Android/iOS parity	1.0
Messaging: WhatsApp BSP, SMS with DLT, opt-in, quiet hours	2.0
Analytics: repeat rate, reward cost, ROI report, exports	1.5
Multi-outlet and franchise hierarchy with roll-ups	1.5
Education module: student and parent profiles, parental consent, campus partners	2.5
Venue-run prepaid packs (ledger only, never holds money) + liability report	1.5
DPDP toolkit: notices, consent records, access and erasure, retention, breach log	1.5
Platform console, support tools, audited impersonation	1.0
QA automation, load tests, security fixes	1.5
Localisation: Hindi, Gujarati, Marathi first	0.8
Total engineering effort	**25.8**

Planning cost per dev-equivalent person-month: Rs 95,000 (mid-level engineer; India salary guides show roughly Rs 6 to 10 lakh a year for full-stack developers; a 30-40% overhead is added). Engineering effort total: 25.8 person-months, about Rs 24.5 lakh before design, QA, product and management.

Delivery options

Delivery option	Team	Months	Build cost (range)	Note
A. Founder-led + AI tools + 1 contract developer	1 contract dev, part-time designer and QA, founders direct and sell	9	Rs 11.2 lakh to Rs 17.4 lakh	Slowest, cheapest. Founders carry product, support and sales.
B. Small in-house team (recommended)	1 tech lead, 2 developers, 1 designer, 1 QA, 1 product/ops	8	Rs 34.9 lakh to Rs 54.5 lakh	Ships the whole backlog; keeps the codebase and know-how in-house.
C. Outsource to an agency	Agency squad (PM, 3-4 engineers, QA, design)	7	Rs 35.3 lakh to Rs 55.1 lakh	Fast start, higher cost, weaker ownership. Needs a strict spec and IP assignment.

One-off launch and compliance costs (estimates)

Item	Estimate	Basis
Company incorporation	Rs 7,000 to 25,000	Published 2026 guides; state stamp duty varies
Trademark search and filing	Rs 15,000 to 50,000	Our estimate incl. professional fees; verify govt fees
Legal drafting: agreements, DPA, privacy, terms	Rs 75,000 to 2,50,000	Our estimate; depends on counsel and review depth
Written opinion on points vs PPI and prepaid packs	Rs 50,000 to 1,50,000	Our estimate
DLT registration (one-time)	about Rs 5,900	Operator platform fee reported by providers
Apple Developer Program	about Rs 8,700 a year	Reported by Indian developers; payment can fail in India, plan a workaround
Penetration test (web app + API)	Rs 50,000 to 2,00,000	Our estimate; yearly
Brand, pitch deck, sales kit, demo videos	Rs 50,000 to 1,50,000	Mostly reuse of existing assets
Cyber insurance (first year)	Rs 30,000 to 1,50,000	Our estimate; get quotes
Contingency	15% of the above	Prudence

Cost to run

Monthly cost at three sizes. Cloud and tool costs are small compared with people, support and compliance.

Cost line (per month)	Pilot up to 25 venues, about 10k members	Growth up to 250 venues, about 150k members	Scale up to 2,000 venues, about 1.5M members
Cloud: database, hosting, storage, bandwidth	Rs 10,000	Rs 60,000	Rs 5.0 lakh
Tools: support desk, CRM, analytics, design, project tools	Rs 8,000	Rs 40,000	Rs 1.5 lakh
Communication set-up and gateway minimums	Rs 5,000	Rs 30,000	Rs 1.5 lakh
Security: scans, monitoring, log archive (averaged)	Rs 5,000	Rs 40,000	Rs 1.5 lakh
Legal, accounting, compliance retainer	Rs 25,000	Rs 80,000	Rs 3.0 lakh
People: team salaries incl. overhead	Rs 2.0 lakh	Rs 7.0 lakh	Rs 26.0 lakh
Total monthly run cost	**Rs 2.5 lakh**	**Rs 9.4 lakh**	**Rs 38.5 lakh**
Assumed average revenue per venue per month	Rs 1,800	Rs 3,500	Rs 5,000
Paying venues needed to break even (at 70% contribution margin)	**201**	**386**	**1,100**
Recurring revenue at the top of the stage (monthly)	Rs 45,000	Rs 8.8 lakh	Rs 1.00 cr

Break-even uses a 70% contribution margin (revenue less messaging, hosting share and per-venue support). It does not include sales commissions or marketing. Growth-stage break-even sits above the stage's own venue count, which tells you something real: the team needed to build integrations and run support costs more than 250 venues can pay for at about Rs 3,500 each, so either price higher, sell more business-tier customers, or keep the team smaller until revenue arrives. The pilot column is an investment stage: with 25 venues it cannot cover its own cost, so it must be funded by founders, the agency or outside money.

Variable costs you can count on

Cost	Rate used	Note
Cloud database and hosting	Supabase Pro about US$25 a month plus compute; Vercel Pro about US$20 per seat (third-party figures; verify)	Converted at Rs 90 per US$ (assumption)
WhatsApp utility message	About Rs 0.115 + provider markup (assumed Rs 0.25)	Free inside a 24-hour customer-service window
WhatsApp marketing message	About Rs 0.86 + markup (assumed Rs 0.25)	Meta can change rates; check the rate card
SMS (OTP and alerts)	About Rs 0.10 to 0.18 per SMS; Rs 0.15 used	After DLT registration
Wallet pass issue and update	No per-pass fee found for Google's API; PassKit charges by active pass volume	Confirm Google's current terms; the direct engine is our cost advantage
Hosting share per active member	Rs 0.15 a month (assumption)	Database rows, storage, bandwidth
Support time	Rs 300 per hour (loaded)	Hours per venue differ by type (below)
Payment gateway for our own subscriptions	Typically a percentage per transaction; UPI autopay is often cheaper than cards	Check the gateway's current pricing

Cost to serve, by business model

What a typical customer of each kind costs us each month, against a suggested price. Prices are hypotheses to test, set so every type earns at least about 60% gross margin before marketing messages, which are passed through.

Example customer	Active members	Suggested price / month	Our cost to serve / month	Gross margin	Marketing messages we pass on (billed at cost +30%)
Cafe, 1 outlet	400	Rs 1,499	Rs 520	66%	Rs 580
Salon / spa, 1 outlet	300	Rs 1,999	Rs 520	74%	Rs 430
Boutique / saree shop	800	Rs 2,499	Rs 580	77%	Rs 1,160
Gym or sports venue	500	Rs 2,999	Rs 1,080	64%	Rs 720
Restaurant chain, 5 outlets	3,000	Rs 9,999	Rs 2,800	72%	Rs 8,680
School, 1 campus (about 1,000 parents)	1,000	Rs 15,000	Rs 3,120	79%	Rs 720
College, 5,000 students	5,000	Rs 40,000	Rs 8,680	78%	Rs 7,240
Supermarket chain, 20 stores	40,000	Rs 1,50,000	Rs 43,300	71%	Rs 1,73,640

Assumptions per row (active members, new members a month, utility and marketing messages per member a month, support hours) are in the model file `data.py` and can be changed. Supermarket and college rows assume integration support is billed separately as setup.

How the cost differs by business model

SMALL VENUES (CAFE, SALON, BOUTIQUE)

Cost is mostly support time and a few hundred utility messages. The business case depends on **self-serve onboarding**: if setup takes a person-day, a Rs 1,499 plan loses money in its first year.

APPOINTMENT AND CAPACITY VENUES (GYM, COURT)

More utility messages (reminders, check-in), more support. Booking-tool integration lowers staff effort and makes the product stick.

CHAINS AND SUPERMARKETS

Cost scales with members and messages, not venues. Integration, security review and procurement are the real costs; recover them with setup fees and annual contracts.

EDUCATION

Moderate message volume, but compliance and relationship work are high. Price per campus per year; budget extra for consent flows, security evidence and onboarding days.

Where the money is made

- Plan fees: the base.
- Messaging markup: small per message, large at volume.
- Managed programme retainers: high margin per venue, but needs people.
- Setup and integration fees for business and enterprise customers.
- Brand-funded campaigns (FMCG and consumer brands pay to reach members of kirana and retail programmes): possible later, only with member consent.

> **Check before relying on these figures.** Every price and cost here is an estimate. Use them to pick the first price list, then replace them with real quotes (BSP, security tester, lawyer, hosting) and real hours logged during the pilots.

Team, operations, support and security

Who does what, by stage

Role	Pilot	Growth	Scale
Founders (product, sales, partners)	2	2	2 (plus heads of function)
Engineering (lead, backend, frontend, integrations)	1 part-time contract	1 lead + 2	6 to 8
Design and product	Part-time	1	2
QA and release	Founder + automation	1	2
Customer success and support	1 part-time	2	6 to 10 (shifts, languages)
Sales and partnerships	Founders	1 to 2	5 to 8
Finance, legal, compliance	Outsourced CA and lawyer	Outsourced + part-time	1 in-house, DPO/grievance officer

Onboarding a venue (target: under one hour)

1. Sign agreement and DPA online
2. Choose preset; set logo, colours, rewards
3. Add staff; send invitations
4. Print QR poster; test join on a phone
5. Staff 15-minute training (video + cheat sheet)
6. First-week check-in call; fix issues

Support model

- In-app help and short videos in Hindi, Gujarati, English first
- WhatsApp support line with business-hour SLA
- Severity levels: S1 (cannot scan or redeem) responds in 1 hour in business hours
- Weekly review of top tickets; fix root causes, not repeats
- Monthly venue health report: scans, members, reward cost, repeat rate

Engineering operations

- Staged releases; automatic tests in CI; rollback plan
- Uptime monitoring and error tracking with alerts to a phone
- Daily backups; restore drill every quarter
- Separate staging and production; no real data in staging
- Secrets only in the host's secret store; rotate on staff exit

Fraud and abuse controls

- One-time redemption codes; duplicate-scan window
- Staff action log; alerts on unusual scan patterns
- Per-day and per-member limits
- Reversal when a bill is cancelled or returned
- Owner approval for manual adjustments

Metrics to run the business on

For venues	For aikia
Members joined; share of customers enrolled; repeat rate versus before; visits per member; reward cost as share of revenue; reactivation of lapsed members	Paying venues; monthly recurring revenue; churn; time to go live; support hours per venue; gross margin; message cost per venue; incidents; payback on acquisition cost

The unglamorous things that decide success

PRODUCT

- **iPhone and no-wallet users.** A large share of customers need a fallback; do not launch with Android-only if the venue's customers skew iPhone.
- **Offline scanning.** Shop Wi-Fi and mobile data fail. The scanner needs a safe offline queue.
- **Returns, cancellations, voids.** Rewards must reverse.
- **Staff turnover.** Staff change monthly in cafes and salons; training must be 15 minutes.
- **Language.** Hindi, Gujarati, Marathi and others on the join page and staff app.
- **Family and household.** Matters for saree, grocery, pharmacy and school.
- **Venue exit.** Owners will ask for their data; build export and deletion.

BUSINESS MODEL

- **Reward economics calculator.** Many owners over-reward. Show the cost of a reward as a share of sales before they publish it.
- **ROI proof.** Renewal depends on a one-page report showing repeat visits up.
- **Points liability.** Unredeemed points are a liability the venue's accountant must see; export it monthly.
- **Venue churn and seasonality.** Sweets, hotels and sports venues have quiet months; consider seasonal billing.
- **Platform dependency.** Google, Apple, Meta or PassKit can change terms. Keep engines and providers swappable.
- **Aggregator terms.** Delivery platforms may restrict steering customers off-platform.

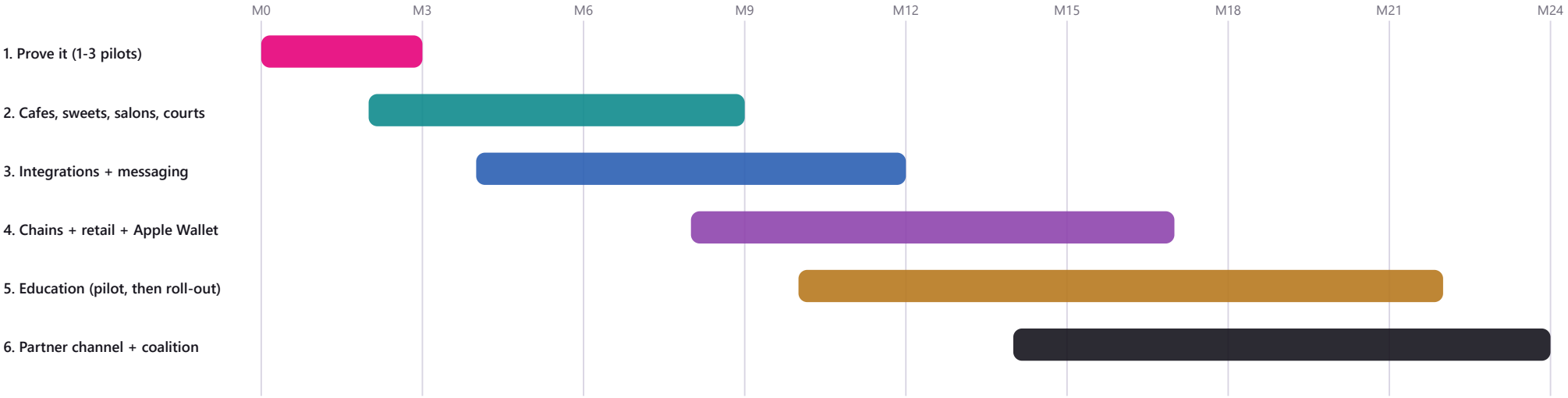
LEGAL AND TRUST

- **Name risk.** "Wallet" may invite RBI-type questions; consider "membership card" in all marketing.
- **Expiry fairness.** Hidden or sudden expiry creates disputes and bad press.
- **Consent for messaging.** A joined member is not automatically opted in for marketing.
- **Dark-pattern rules.** Keep consent screens honest.
- **Contractors' IP.** Get assignments signed.
- **Insurance.** Cyber and professional indemnity.

GROWTH AND OPERATIONS

- **The POS question is the first question every chain asks.**
- **Partner enablement.** Resellers need demo accounts, price lists, training and a lead-sharing rule.
- **Billing the venues.** Subscriptions, GST invoices, failed-payment handling, dunning.
- **Venue success management.** A monthly call in the first 90 days cuts churn.
- **Data in India.** Choose an India region for the database and keep logs in India.
- **Accessibility.** Large text and high contrast for the staff and card screens.

Chart 5. Suggested 24-month path (stage gates, not promises)



Gate to move on: each stage needs paying venues, a repeat-rate lift you can show, clean support load, and no open legal issue.

MONTHS 0 TO 3

- Legal base, DLT, trademark check
- 3 pilots: cafe, sweets (RUH), salon or court
- Cafe, bakery, salon presets
- Real-phone Google card test; Apple account started
- Price list v1

MONTHS 3 TO 12

- Billing and plans; self-serve onboarding
- WhatsApp and SMS layer
- POS wave 1; ROI report
- Penetration test; DPDP toolkit
- 25 to 100 paying venues

MONTHS 12 TO 24

- Multi-outlet and enterprise pack
- Apple Wallet live
- Campus pilot, then schools
- Partner channel (POS resellers, distributors)
- Venue-run packs, with counsel sign-off

Risks to manage

Risk	Why it matters	Mitigation
Regulatory drift on stored value	RBI PPI rules are being redrawn in 2026	Points only now; counsel opinion before packs; watch RBI notices quarterly
Data breach or misuse	Penalties are large; trust is the product	Minimal data; security test; insurance; drilled runbook
Wallet platform changes	Google or Apple can change terms or limits	Swappable engines; web-card fallback
Low venue adoption by staff	If scanning is slow, staff stop	10-second scan target; training; owner incentives
Small-venue unit economics	Support time can erase margin	Self-serve onboarding; partner-led support; higher minimum plan
Integration dependence	POS vendors can refuse or change APIs	CSV and webhook fallback; partnerships
Education sales cycle	Slow decisions drain a small team	One campus pilot; do not hire ahead of revenue
Founder bandwidth	Product, sales and compliance at once	Stage gates; outsource legal and accounts; hire support first

Decisions we need from the founders

1. Confirm **points only** as the launch money model.
2. Choose delivery **Option A, B or C** and a monthly budget ceiling.
3. Pick the **three pilot venues** and the first campus.
4. Set the **first price list** (Starter, Growth, Business) to test.
5. Name the **owner for legal and compliance** (a founder plus outside counsel and a CA).
6. Decide whether to start the **Apple Developer account** now.
7. Decide the **brand language**: "wallet" or "membership card".

What this research did not settle

- Final text of the RBI PPI Master Direction after the 2026 draft; whether points fall outside it, in writing.
- Exact current TRAI rules for promotional messaging, and Meta's current India rate card.
- Google Wallet's current terms on fees, message limits and issuer approval in India.
- Competitor features and prices beyond a single comparison page.
- Official counts of restaurants, salons and retail outlets (sources are estimates).
- Whether our assumed prices will be accepted by venues; the pilots decide.

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